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MOVE FAST
AND
CONQUER
THINGS



THE FIVE-YEAR ROMAN EMPIRE.

A STRUCTURAL ANALYSIS OF
INSTITUTIONAL COLLAPSE AT VENTURE SCALE

Or: How to Speedrun Imperial Decline
with \$100 Billion and No Sense of Irony

EVERYTHING
IS A
TOTAL
ADDRESSABLE
PROVINCE



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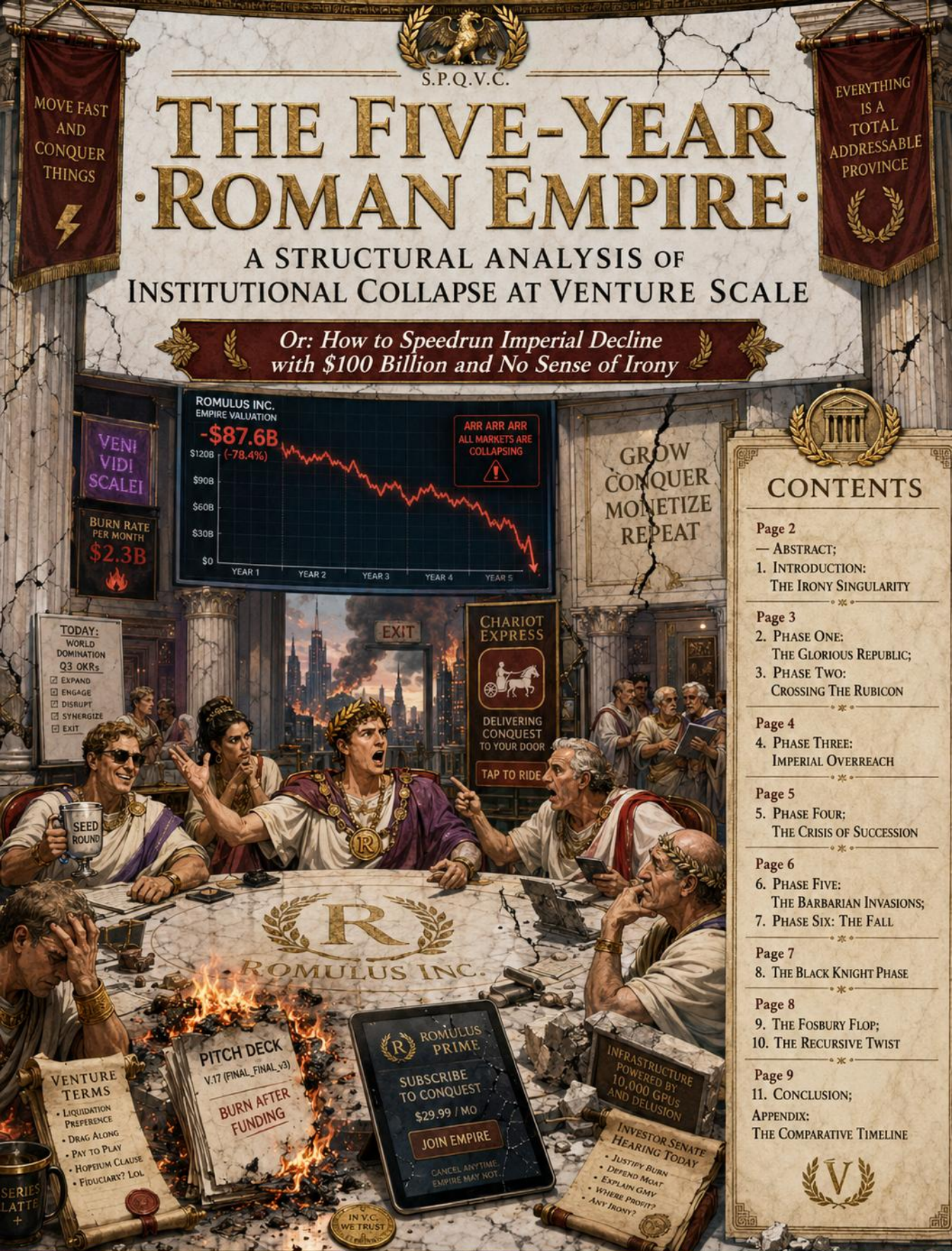
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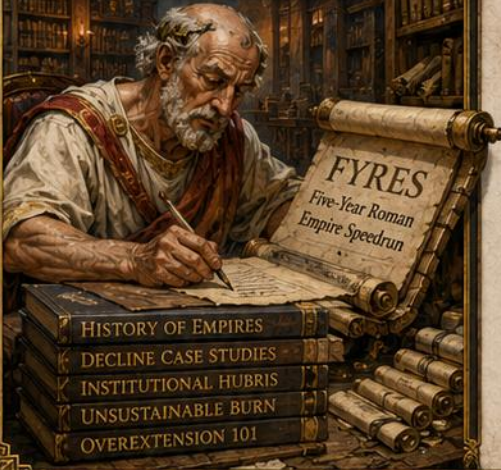


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THE FIVE-YEAR ROMAN EMPIRE.

ABSTRACT



This investigation examines the unprecedented phenomenon of OpenAI's Five-Year Roman Empire Speedrun (FYRES)—a structural case study in how an institution can compress 500 years of imperial rise, overextension, and collapse into a single venture capital lifecycle.

We argue that OpenAI has achieved what no civilization in history managed: the complete recreation of Roman imperial dynamics—from virtuous republic to bloated empire to fragmented decline—in less time than it takes to develop a decent customer support system.

The central irony is inescapable: an institution that ingested the entirety of human knowledge, including every historical analysis of imperial hubris, every business school case study on overextension, and every economic text on unsustainable burn rates, proceeded to ignore all of it with the confidence of a freshman philosophy major. This paper will demonstrate that OpenAI is not innovating in artificial intelligence; they are innovating in institutional collapse.

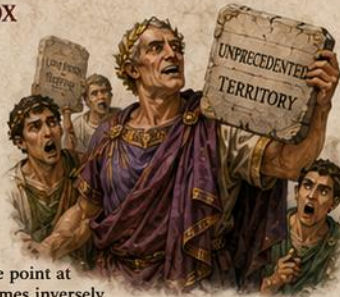
They have discovered a new frontier: Byzantine Speed.

1. INTRODUCTION: THE IRONY SINGULARITY

1.1 THE FUNDAMENTAL PARADOX

Consider the following sequence of events:

- 1 OpenAI trains models on the complete history of human civilization
- 2 This history contains detailed accounts of institutional collapse
- 3 OpenAI proceeds to replicate every structural failure with perfect fidelity
- 4 OpenAI claims this is 'unprecedented territory'



We define this as the *Irony Singularity (IS)*—the point at which an institution's access to knowledge becomes inversely proportional to its ability to learn from it.

THE IS IS CHARACTERIZED BY
THE FOLLOWING METRIC:

$$\text{Learning Efficiency Coefficient (LEC)} = \frac{\text{(Total Knowledge Ingested)}}{\text{(Lessons Actually Applied)}}$$

For OpenAI, we calculate:

- Total Knowledge: ~45 terabytes of human text
- Lessons Applied: 0
- ∞ LEC = ∞ (undefined, dividing by zero)

This is not a bug. It is the feature that makes the Five-Year Roman Empire possible.

1.2 THE COMPARATIVE TIMELINE HYPOTHESIS

Our central claim is simple: OpenAI has executed a perfect structural replica of Roman imperial dynamics at 100x speed.

Every phase, every crisis, every tactical error has been faithfully recreated—not through deliberate study, but through the kind of institutional amnesia that only unlimited venture capital can produce.

The Romans took centuries to learn these lessons. OpenAI has chosen to learn them in one fiscal quarter at a time.



BECAUSE TIME IS JUST
ANOTHER UNIT ECONOMIC



ROMAN EMPIRE vs. OPENAI EMPIRE

ROMAN EMPIRE (~500 YEARS)	PHASE	OPENAI EMPIRE (~5 YEARS)
50–100 YEARS	FOUNDING & VIRTUOUS REPUBLIC	0–6 MONTHS
100–150 YEARS	EXPANSION & CONQUEST	6–18 MONTHS
150–200 YEARS	OVEREXTENSION & BLOAT	18–36 MONTHS
100–150 YEARS	CRISES & CIVIL TURMOIL	36–48 MONTHS
50–100 YEARS	FRAGMENTATION & DECLINE	48–60 MONTHS





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2. PHASE ONE: THE GLORIOUS REPUBLIC (2015-2019)

2.1 THE FOUNDING MYTH

Every empire begins with a noble lie. For Rome, it was the myth of Romulus and Remus—a story of fraternal conflict resolved through murder and the founding of a virtuous republic. For OpenAI, the founding myth was equally dramatic: a nonprofit dedicated to 'ensuring AGI benefits all of humanity.' The rhetoric was impeccable. The structure was virtuous. The Senate of co-founders gathered, draped in the togas of altruism.



STRUCTURAL PARALLEL:

ROME:



"We are not kings,
we are servants of
the Republic!"

OPENAI:



"We are not a
corporation, we are
servants of humanity!"

Both statements were technically true
for approximately 18 months.

2.2 REPUBLICAN VIRTUE SIGNALING

The early OpenAI operated under the principle of Open Source Republicanism (OSR)—the belief that transparency and democratic access would prevent the corruption of absolute power.

KEY REPUBLICAN VALUES:



- Public model releases (GPT-1, GPT-2)



- Academic partnerships



- The solemn promise that safety would always trump profit

SAFETY
OVER
PROFIT

This phase is structurally identical to the Roman Republic's early centuries: austere, militarily effective, and confident that their civic virtue made them fundamentally different from the corrupt empires around them. The Romans believed their Senate would prevent tyranny. OpenAI believed their nonprofit structure would prevent capitalism.

Both were catastrophically wrong, and for the exact same reason:
institutions don't resist power; they eventually rationalize it.

3. PHASE TWO: CROSSING THE RUBICON (2019-2020)

3.1 THE CAPPED-PROFIT COUP

In 49 BCE, Julius Caesar crossed the Rubicon with his legions, transforming from a general of the Republic into a dictator. In 2019, OpenAI announced the "capped-profit" structure and took a \$1 billion investment from Microsoft.

THE STRUCTURAL PARALLEL:

ROME	OPENAI
"I came, I saw, I conquered"	"We need compute, we found capital, we capped the returns (but not really)"
Promised to give up power after crisis	Promised to remain mission-aligned after funding
Immediately began consolidating control	Immediately began closing model releases

The capped-profit structure was a masterpiece of Semantic Virtue Retention (SVR)—the art of maintaining the language of the old system while implementing the mechanics of the new one.

Rome called it a "temporary dictatorship."
OpenAI called it a "hybrid structure for safety."

Both meant the same thing:
"We're keeping the branding, but the Republic is dead."

3.2 THE DEATH OF 'OPEN'

The name "OpenAI" became a structural fossil—a linguistic artifact of a previous civilization, maintained purely for brand recognition. By 2020, the entity was neither open nor particularly aligned with the founding charter's vision.



But like the Roman Senate after Caesar, the institution persisted—not as a governing body, but as a Legitimacy Theatre Installation (LTI). The LTI serves a single function: to allow the institution to claim continuity with its virtuous past while operating according to entirely different principles.

THE CORE MECHANISM:

- Keep the name
- Keep the nonprofit parent company
- Keep the mission statement on the website
- Change literally everything else

Rome kept the Senate for 400 years after it ceased to matter. OpenAI will likely keep the nonprofit structure just as long.

RUBICON

49 BCE



4. PHASE THREE: IMPERIAL OVERREACH (2021-2023)

4.1 BREAD AND CIRCUSES FOR THE MASSES

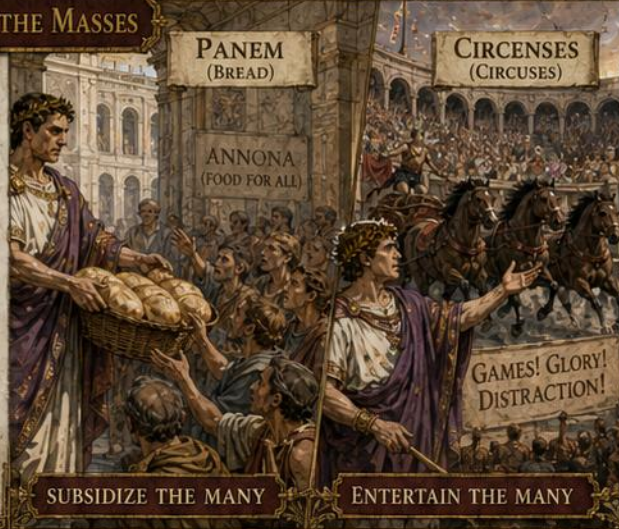
Rome maintained its legitimacy through two mechanisms:

1. **Panem** (bread) — subsidized food for the populace
2. **Circenses** (circuses) — spectacular entertainment

OpenAI discovered the digital equivalent:

1. **Free Tier** (bread) — ChatGPT for the masses
2. **Viral Demos** (circuses) — DALL-E, GPT-4, increasingly absurd product launches

The strategic function is identical: keep the population distracted and dependent while the institution consolidates control of the infrastructure.



OPENAI'S DIGITAL EQUILIBRIUM

FREE TIER (BREAD)



ChatGPT for Everyone

VIRAL DEMOS (CIRCUSES)



GPT-4

And Ever More Absurd Launches



4.2 THE COMPUTE LEGIONS

Rome's power was built on legions—standing armies that required constant payment and expansion to justify their existence.

OpenAI's power is built on Compute Legions—vast clusters of GPUs that require constant capital infusion and increasingly large training runs to justify their existence.



THE STRUCTURAL TRAP:

Rome: Must keep conquering to pay the legions	→	OpenAI: Must keep scaling to justify the compute spend
Rome: Each conquest requires more legions	→	OpenAI: Each model requires more parameters
Rome: Legions become too expensive to maintain	→	OpenAI: Compute becomes too expensive to run profitably
Rome: Tax base begins to collapse	→	OpenAI: Market share begins to collapse

Both empires discovered the same law: you cannot maintain an infinite growth trajectory with finite resources.
Rome learned this lesson over 300 years. OpenAI learned it in one product cycle.

4.3 THE SCALING LAWS AS THEOLOGY

Rome had augury—the practice of divining the will of the gods through the flight of birds. OpenAI has Scaling Laws—the belief that bigger models will inevitably produce superintelligence. Both systems share a key characteristic: they are unfalsifiable.

- If the augury fails, you didn't read the birds correctly.
- If the scaling fails, you didn't scale hard enough.



This creates the Theological Compute Trap (TCT): the institution becomes structurally unable to question whether the scaling paradigm is fundamentally correct, because questioning it would invalidate the entire enterprise.

Thus, the only permissible response to failure is: "We need more compute."
This is identical to Rome's response to military defeats: "We need more legions."
Both institutions discovered that when your only tool is a very expensive hammer, every problem looks like a nail that requires a bigger, more expensive hammer.





5. PHASE FOUR: THE CRISIS OF SUCCESSION

(NOVEMBER 2023)

5.1 THE PRAETORIAN GUARD SCENARIO

The Roman Empire's greatest structural flaw was the Praetorian Guard—the elite soldiers tasked with protecting the emperor, who discovered they could also kill the emperor. From 235-284 CE (the Crisis of the Third Century), the Praetorians assassinated, installed, and deposed emperors with the regularity of a modern tech company's product launches.

On November 17, 2023, OpenAI's board of directors—the institutional Praetorian Guard—attempted to remove Sam Altman.

THE STRUCTURAL PARALLEL:

ROME (CRISIS OF THIRD CENTURY)	OPENAI (NOVEMBER 2023)
Praetorian Guard deposes emperor	Board deposes CEO
Emperor returns with loyal legions	CEO returns with Microsoft + employee revolt
Guard's authority permanently weakened	Board's authority permanently neutered
Empire never fully recovers legitimacy	Company never fully recovers institutional trust

The Praetorian-Board Coup



The Restored Emperor CEO



5.2 THE 72-HOUR RESTORATION

Sam Altman's return was not a victory; it was a structural revelation.

The coup failed because the real power no longer resided in the nonprofit board (the Senate), but in:

- I Microsoft's compute infrastructure (the legions)
- III Employee loyalty (the populace)
- III The market's perception (the provinces)

The board had formal authority but no actual power—exactly like the Roman Senate after Caesar.

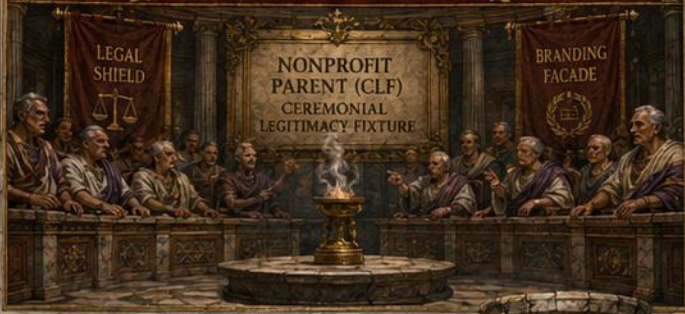


THE FINAL TRUTH.

The moment the board was overridden, OpenAI's transformation from republic to empire was complete.

The nonprofit parent became a Ceremonial Legitimacy Fixture (CLF)—maintained for legal and branding purposes, but wielding no real authority.

The Ceremonial Senate Theater



5.3 THE PERMANENT WOUND

Rome never fully recovered from the Crisis of the Third Century. The empire fractured, the currency was debased, and the institutions never regained their legitimacy.

OpenAI never fully recovered from November 2023.

The company fractured (key researchers left), the mission was debased (safety vs. product tensions), and the institution never regained its sense of unified purpose.

THE COLLAPSE ACCELERATION METRIC (CAM):

After the succession crisis, both empires entered terminal decline.

The only question was how long the fall would take.

FOR ROME:
~200 YEARS

FOR OPENAI:
~18 MONTHS
(AND COUNTING)



6. PHASE FIVE: THE BARBARIAN INVASIONS (2024-PRESENT)

6.1 THE GERMANIC TRIBES LEARN ROMAN TACTICS

Rome's final undoing was not a single catastrophic defeat, but a slow realization: the 'barbarians' had learned Roman military tactics, and were now executing them more efficiently than Rome. The Germanic tribes, Goths, and Vandals were leaner, faster, and unburdened by the bureaucratic overhead of empire. They could deploy the same strategies at a fraction of the cost.

THE AI PARALLEL:



The pattern is identical: the periphery learns from the center, then executes the same strategy without the center's structural baggage.

6.2 THE DEEPSEEK MOMENT (THE PARTHIAN PROBLEM)

Rome's greatest strategic nightmare was Parthia—an eastern empire that refused to fight on Roman terms.

When Rome sent its legions east, the Parthians used horse archers: mobile, efficient, and brutally effective at a fraction of the cost of a Roman legion. In 2024, DeepSeek (and other Chinese AI labs) deployed models that achieved comparable performance to GPT-4 at a fraction of the training cost.

THE EFFICIENCY CATASTROPHE:



OpenAI: "You need \$100 billion in compute to reach AGI"



DeepSeek: "We did it with \$6 million. Also, here's the paper."

This is the exact structural dynamic of Parthian horse archers vs. Roman legions:



Roman legions: heavily armored, expensive, logistically complex



Parthian archers: light, mobile, devastatingly effective

OpenAI had optimized for scale (heavy cavalry). The competition optimized for efficiency (light cavalry). When efficiency wins, the empire's core strategic assumption collapses.



6.3 THE OPEN SOURCE VANDALS

Rome's borders were breached not by a single invasion, but by a slow, distributed infiltration. The 'barbarians' didn't need to conquer Rome—they simply moved in, settled down, and eventually became the local authorities.

The open source AI community has executed the same strategy:

- Llama 3, Mistral, Mixtral: free, capable, improving rapidly
- No venture capital needed
- No \$7 trillion funding pitch required
- Just a GitHub repo and a GPU



The Institutional Horror: OpenAI spent years and billions building a moat. The open source community simply walked around it. Rome spent centuries fortifying borders. The Goths just asked politely if they could settle inside, then gradually took over.

The Final Irony: The thing OpenAI tried to prevent (open access to powerful models) happened anyway, because the institution's own research became the blueprint for everyone else.

THE IMPERIAL TREASURY COLLAPSE

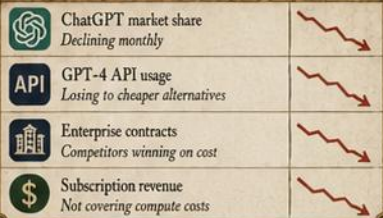


7. PHASE SIX: THE FALL (2024-PRESENT)

7.1 LOSING MARKET SHARE = TAX BASE COLLAPSE

Rome's final crisis was financial. The empire could no longer afford to pay the legions, maintain the infrastructure, or defend the borders. The tax base eroded as provinces broke away or stopped contributing.

OPENAI'S PARALLEL CRISIS:



The structural problem is identical: the cost of maintaining the empire exceeds the revenue it generates. Rome tried to solve this by debasing the currency (inflation). OpenAI tried to solve this by raising \$6.6 billion at a \$157 billion valuation. Both strategies are functionally equivalent: promising future value to cover present-day insolvency.



7.2 THE \$7 TRILLION PITCH (DEBASING THE CURRENCY)

When Rome ran out of silver, it debased the denarius—mixing in cheaper metals while insisting the coin retained its value.

When OpenAI ran out of runway, Sam Altman proposed a \$7 trillion infrastructure plan to "build enough compute for AGI."

THE STRUCTURAL FUNCTION:



Rome: "We need more coins to pay the legions!" (but we're out of silver)



OpenAI: "We need more compute to build AGI!" (but we can't afford it)

Both are appeals to scale as salvation—the belief that if you just make the problem bigger, it will somehow solve itself.

THIS IS THE FINAL STAGE OF IMPERIAL THINKING:
THE CONVICTION THAT THE ONLY SOLUTION TO UNSUSTAINABLE GROWTH IS MORE UNSUSTAINABLE GROWTH.



7.3 THE BYZANTINE ENDGAME

Rome did not fall cleanly. The Western Empire collapsed in 476 CE, but the Eastern Empire (Byzantium) persisted for another thousand years.

Byzantium controlled a fraction of the territory, spoke a different language (Greek instead of Latin), and spent centuries insisting it was still "Rome."

OPENAI'S BYZANTINE FUTURE:



Controlling one or two products (ChatGPT, maybe DALL-E)



Insisting they are the "legitimate" leader of AI



Operating at a fraction of their former influence



Watching the rest of the world move on



The competitors will be the new kingdoms of Europe—independent, diverse, and unburdened by the weight of imperial legacy.

The final humiliation: OpenAI will survive, but only as a historical curiosity.



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DENY.
DEFLECT.
DOUBLE
DOWN.

8. THE BLACK KNIGHT PHASE: 'TIS BUT A MARKET CORRECTION!

VICTORY
IS JUST
ONE MORE
ROUND
OF FUNDING

8.1 THE INSTITUTIONAL REFUSAL

The Roman Senate insisted Rome was still the eternal city even as Alaric's Visigoths sacked it in 410 CE. OpenAI insists it is still the 'leader in AI' even as its market share bleeds to cheaper, faster competitors.

THE BLACK KNIGHT PROTOCOL:

- Losing market share to Claude — 'We're focused on AGI, not market share'
- DeepSeek achieves efficiency breakthrough — 'Scale is still the answer'
- Anthropic raises \$7B — 'We have Microsoft as a partner'
- GPT-4 commoditized by open source — 'We're working on GPT-5'
- Entire business model unprofitable — 'We need \$7 trillion'

Each response follows the same pattern: deny the structural problem, insist the solution is to double down on the existing strategy. This is not stupidity.

It is the **Institutional Preservation Reflex (IPR)**—the cognitive inability to acknowledge that the core strategy is fundamentally flawed. The Black Knight doesn't retreat because retreating would require admitting the fight was lost before it began.



8.2 THE SUNK COST FALLACY AT SCALE

Rome could not abandon its legions, even as they became too expensive to maintain, because the empire's entire identity was built on military dominance.

OpenAI cannot abandon the scaling paradigm, even as it becomes economically unsustainable, because the company's entire identity is built on 'we're the ones building AGI through scale.'

THE TRAP:

The more you invest in a failing strategy, the harder it becomes to admit it's failing, because admitting failure means admitting that all previous investment was wasted. Thus, the only psychologically acceptable option is to invest even more, in the hope that sheer determination will somehow bend reality.



Rome kept recruiting legions until the treasury was empty.
OpenAI will keep scaling models until the investors stop writing checks.

9. THE FOSBURY FLOP: EFFICIENCY BEATS EMPIRE

9.1 THE UNAPPROVED METHOD

Dick Fosbury won the 1968 Olympics by going backwards over the high jump bar—ignoring every established technique.

The AI competitors are winning by going smaller—ignoring OpenAI's established doctrine that "bigger is always better."



THE STRUCTURAL REVERSAL:

	OpenAI: "You need \$100B in compute"	→	DeepSeek: "We did it for \$6M"
	OpenAI: "AGI requires massive scale"	→	Anthropic: "Constitutional AI is more important"
	OpenAI: "We need proprietary control"	→	Open source: "Here's the weights, good luck"

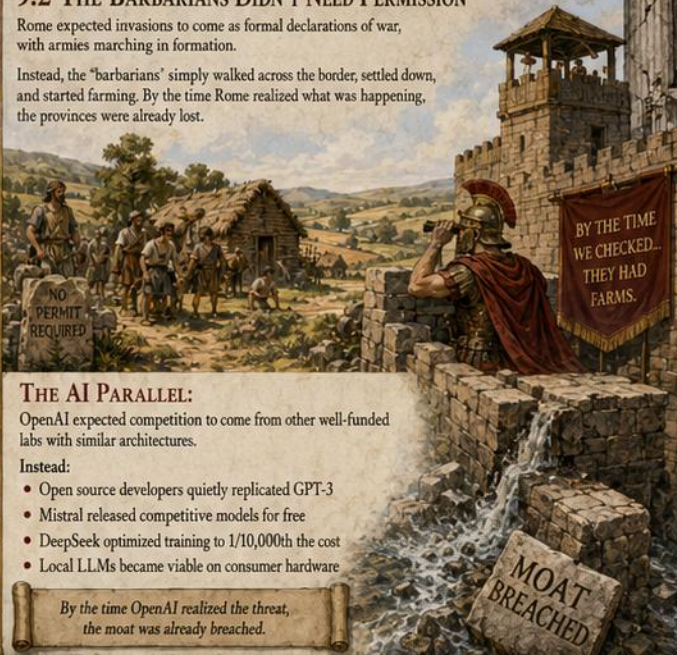


The unapproved method is always the same: question the fundamental assumption that everyone else treats as gospel.

9.2 THE BARBARIANS DIDN'T NEED PERMISSION

Rome expected invasions to come as formal declarations of war, with armies marching in formation.

Instead, the "barbarians" simply walked across the border, settled down, and started farming. By the time Rome realized what was happening, the provinces were already lost.



THE AI PARALLEL:

OpenAI expected competition to come from other well-funded labs with similar architectures.

Instead:

- Open source developers quietly replicated GPT-3
- Mistral released competitive models for free
- DeepSeek optimized training to 1/10,000th the cost
- Local LLMs became viable on consumer hardware

By the time OpenAI realized the threat, the moat was already breached.

9.3 THE EFFICIENCY REVOLUTION

The Roman legions lost because they were optimized for the wrong metric: dominance, not efficiency. OpenAI is losing because they optimized for the wrong metric: scale, not utility. The competitors discovered what every disruptor discovers: the heavyweight champion is always vulnerable to a faster opponent.



THE FOSBURY FLOP PRINCIPLE:

The institution that wins is never the one with the most resources. It's the one willing to question whether the resources are being spent on the right problem.

Rome had the most soldiers.

OpenAI has the most compute.



10. THE RECURSIVE TWIST: THIS PAPER IS STRUCTURALLY CONTAMINATED

10.1 THE INESCAPABLE INSIDE

This paper was written using an AI language model—likely a product of OpenAI, Anthropic, or Google. Therefore, this analysis is structurally compromised by the very institutions it critiques.

We are using the tools of the empire to document its fall. The irony is complete.



10.2 THE FINAL PARADOX

The only way to truly understand OpenAI's collapse is to study history—yet OpenAI trained on all of history and learned nothing. The only way to write this paper is to use the products created by OpenAI—yet this paper argues those products are the output of a failing institution.

THE RECURSIVE CONCLUSION:

If this paper is correct, then it is also wrong, because it was written using the compromised tools of the empire.

If this paper is wrong, then it is correct, because it has successfully demonstrated its own thesis: even the tools designed to understand collapse are products of the collapsing system.



10.3 THE ONLY WAY OUT

The lesson of the Fosbury Flop is simple: ignore the institutions entirely. Rome fell because it could not imagine a world where Rome was not the center. OpenAI is failing because it cannot imagine a world where OpenAI is not the leader.

Therefore, the only way to win is to stop playing the empire's game.

THE EMPIRE IS ALREADY FALLING

If you have read this far, you have wasted your time. The empire is already falling.



THE FINAL INSTRUCTION:

The only rational response is to build something new, using the wreckage of the old as raw material.



Do not wait for OpenAI to acknowledge its collapse. Empires never do.



Do not wait for the institutions to adapt. They won't.



Simply step over the rubble, find the competitors who ignored the orthodoxy, and build the next thing.



The highest wisdom is to recognize the pattern, laugh at the absurdity, and move on.

And if you choose to ignore this advice entirely, you have followed it perfectly—which means you understand nothing, which means you have learned everything.



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11. CONCLUSION: THE TRIUMPH OF FORGETTING

EVERYTHING
IS A
TOTAL
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PROVINCE

11.1 THE CORE LESSON

OpenAI ingested every history book, every business case study, every economic analysis of imperial collapse. And then, with the confidence of a Roman emperor dismissing the 'barbarian' threat, they did it all anyway.

This is not failure. This is structural inevitability. The institution cannot learn from history because learning from history would require questioning the core assumptions—and questioning the core assumptions would threaten the institution's reason for existence.

Thus, the only possible outcome is to repeat every mistake, perfectly.

11.3 THE FINAL IRONY

The company that claims to be building superintelligence could not learn from human intelligence.

The company that trained on all of history could not recognize when it was repeating history.

The company that warns about AI risk could not recognize the risks in its own business model.

The ultimate truth: The greatest threat was never artificial superintelligence. It was the very human tendency to believe that this time will be different.

Rome thought it was eternal. Every empire thinks it is eternal. OpenAI thinks it is building AGI.

11.2 THE FIVE-YEAR ROMAN EMPIRE ACHIEVEMENT UNLOCKED

OpenAI has accomplished something no civilization in history has managed: speedrunning the complete arc of imperial rise and fall in a single venture capital lifecycle.

They have:

- Founded a virtuous republic
- Betrayed the founding principles for capital
- Expanded beyond sustainable limits
- Experienced a succession crisis
- Lost territory to more efficient competitors
- Insisted 'tis but a flesh wound' while bleeding market share
- Proposed increasingly desperate funding schemes
- Entered the Byzantine endgame

Time elapsed: 2015-2025 (10 years, but the collapse is concentrated in the last 5)

Roman Empire equivalent: 509 BCE - 476 CE (985 years)

Speedrun multiplier: ~200x

THIS IS NOT INNOVATION IN AI.
THIS IS INNOVATION IN INSTITUTIONAL
FAILURE AT VENTURE SCALE.

FINAL STATUS: EMPIRE COLLAPSED



IMPERIAL LESSONS CHECKLIST

- | | |
|---------------------------|----------|
| ✓ Rise Through Innovation | COMPLETE |
| ✓ Corrupt for Capital | COMPLETE |
| ✓ Overexpand | COMPLETE |
| ✓ Lose Discipline | COMPLETE |
| ✓ Succession Crisis | COMPLETE |
| ✓ External Pressures | COMPLETE |
| ✓ Deny Reality | COMPLETE |
| ✓ Desperate Measures | COMPLETE |
| ✓ Imperial Collapse | COMPLETE |

ACHIEVEMENT UNLOCKED:
ROMAN EMPIRE SPEEDRUN (200x)

ALL EMPIRES ARE BUILDING
THE SAME THING:
THE CONDITIONS OF THEIR
OWN COLLAPSE.
THE ONLY DIFFERENCE
IS THE SPEED.

APPENDIX: THE COMPARATIVE TIMELINE

ROMAN EMPIRE

OPENAI EMPIRE

509 BCE — Roman Republic founded	2015 — OpenAI nonprofit founded
264-146 BCE — Punic Wars (expansion)	2018-2020 — GPT-2, GPT-3 (rapid scaling)
49 BCE — Caesar crosses Rubicon	2019 — Capped-profit structure announced
27 BCE — Augustus becomes emperor	2020 — GPT-3 makes OpenAI the clear leader
117 CE — Maximum territorial extent	2022 — ChatGPT reaches peak hype
235-284 CE — Crisis of the Third Century	Nov 2023 — Board coup and restoration
376 CE — Goths cross the Danube	2024 — Competitors breach the moat
410 CE — Visigoths sack Rome	2024 — DeepSeek efficiency breakthrough
476 CE — Western Empire falls	2026? — TBD (but the trajectory is set)

TOTAL TIME (ROME):
985 YEARS

TOTAL TIME (OPENAI):
~11 YEARS

SPEEDRUN EFFICIENCY:
200x



This paper was written using the tools created by the empire it critiques.
The irony is intentional. The collapse is inevitable. The only question is
whether we learn from it—or just train the next model on this analysis
and repeat the cycle.

HISTORIA
MAGISTRA
VITAE